

DRY SOIL

Dry desert soils are home to plants that can live without rain for long periods of time. Plants are few and far between, but they have amazing abilities to absorb water.

Prickles protect the stem from thirsty creatures.

A chunky stem stores water for the plant to use.

Cactus

A network of shallow, wide-spreading roots helps the plant drink as much water as possible if it rains.

Thick, spongy bark holds water.

The roots can go far to find water.

A pebbly disguise puts off plant-eating animals.

Living stones

Pebble plants can absorb water from fog. During droughts they shrink below ground, so they need even less water.

Some cacti can last for two years without rain.

Saxaul tree

This tree's root networks hold large amounts of dry sand in place. Planting more of them stops soil blowing away.